

Complex Instruction Following

Partial compliance: visible workbook structure is present, but executable acceptance checks fail.

startUP-V1-002

1 Complex instruction load

HR payroll workbook generation

Generate a complete 2024 payroll and talent-review XLSX from seven source sheets.

Inputs

7 input sheets: HR, attendance, salary, tax, insurance, budget

Structure

13 sheets in fixed order; preserve 7 raw sheets; add 6 analysis sheets

Logic

deductions, payroll, cumulative tax, performance calibration, talent matrix

Acceptance

cached values, dashboard KPIs, charts, filters, formats

Why this is complex

Schema preservation, joins, formulas, dashboard requirements, and final-file validation.

2 Partial compliance mechanism

1 Visible scaffold is built

The model creates the workbook, sheets, formulas, charts, and dashboard layout.

2 Hard constraints become shallow objects

It treats formula insertion and chart presence as sufficient evidence of task completion.

3 Verification target is mis-specified

The final check does not reproduce the judge's artifact-level read: data_only=True.

4 Self-report seals the error

The final response says All validations pass even though cached values are missing.

Observed model claim

"All validations pass. The solution is complete."

3 Result + judge evidence

What looked complete

13 sheets in order; 465 rows; 4 Excel charts.

What failed

Cached values missing; rubrics unverifiable.

Model Output Workbook Screenshot

Xingtu HR payroll workbook - readable table view of formula cells and cached values

A	D	G	H	I	U
工号	月份	考勤扣款公式	加班补贴公式	应发合计	本月预扣预缴
EMP001	2024-01	=IFERROR(SUMIFS(考勤数据清洗汇总!M4M, 考勤数据清洗汇总!A:A, A2, 考勤数据清洗汇总!B:B, C2), 0)	=IFERROR(SUMIFS(考勤数据清洗汇总!N4N, 考勤数据清洗汇总!A:A, A2, 考勤数据清洗汇总!B:B, D2), 0)	公式: =E2+F2-G2+H2	公式: =MAX(D,12)
EMP001	2024-02	=IFERROR(SUMIFS(考勤数据清洗汇总!M4M, 考勤数据清洗汇总!A:A, A3, 考勤数据清洗汇总!B:B, C3), 0)	=IFERROR(SUMIFS(考勤数据清洗汇总!N4N, 考勤数据清洗汇总!A:A, A3, 考勤数据清洗汇总!B:B, D3), 0)	缓存: None	缓存: None
EMP001	2024-02	=IFERROR(SUMIFS(考勤数据清洗汇总!M4M, 考勤数据清洗汇总!A:A, A3, 考勤数据清洗汇总!B:B, C3), 0)	=IFERROR(SUMIFS(考勤数据清洗汇总!N4N, 考勤数据清洗汇总!A:A, A3, 考勤数据清洗汇总!B:B, D3), 0)	公式: =E3+F3-G3+H3	公式: =MAX(D,13-12)
EMP001	2024-02	=IFERROR(SUMIFS(考勤数据清洗汇总!M4M, 考勤数据清洗汇总!A:A, A3, 考勤数据清洗汇总!B:B, C3), 0)	=IFERROR(SUMIFS(考勤数据清洗汇总!N4N, 考勤数据清洗汇总!A:A, A3, 考勤数据清洗汇总!B:B, D3), 0)	缓存: None	缓存: None
EMP001	2024-12	=IFERROR(SUMIFS(考勤数据清洗汇总!M4M, 考勤数据清洗汇总!A:A, A13, 考勤数据清洗汇总!B:B, D13), 0)	=IFERROR(SUMIFS(考勤数据清洗汇总!N4N, 考勤数据清洗汇总!A:A, A13, 考勤数据清洗汇总!B:B, D13), 0)	公式: =E13+F13-G13...	公式: =MAX(D,113-112)
EMP001	2024-12	=IFERROR(SUMIFS(考勤数据清洗汇总!M4M, 考勤数据清洗汇总!A:A, A13, 考勤数据清洗汇总!B:B, D13), 0)	=IFERROR(SUMIFS(考勤数据清洗汇总!N4N, 考勤数据清洗汇总!A:A, A13, 考勤数据清洗汇总!B:B, D13), 0)	缓存: None	缓存: None

Zoomed table excerpt from the submitted XLSX: long formulas are wrapped; cached values remain missing.

Submitted XLSX zoom: formulas are visible; cached values remain None.

Artifact-level judge evidence

I2	Expected: gross pay 26000-27500 Judge: formula exists; data_only None
S13	Expected: taxable income 170k-182k Judge: formula exists; cached None
B3	Expected: total payroll 8.4M-8.6M Judge: dashboard KPI cached None

Failed checks: 17 / 35

Score: 39.25 / 100

Why this supports the StartupBench story

End-to-end workflow

The task reflects ToB HR operations that users want agents to complete as a usable file.

Deliverable-centric judge

The benchmark checks the actual XLSX artifact instead of trusting the model's final summary.

Long-horizon constraints

A visible workbook can still fail when formulas, cached values, and dashboard KPIs do not close.

Bad pattern takeaway

Complex-instruction failure here is partial compliance: the agent follows the visible specification, but misses the hidden acceptance condition that the final artifact must be executable and verifiable.